



Shawwna Harbin <atlasmom421@gmail.com>

Fwd: Serious issues at work - Shawwna Harbin

1 message

Shawwna Harbin <ellemh13@gmail.com>
To: Shawwna Harbin <atlasmom421@gmail.com>

Wed, Oct 22, 2025 at 10:17 AM

----- Forwarded message -----

From: **Shawwna Harbin** <ellemh13@gmail.com>
Date: Wed, May 29, 2024 at 3:29 PM
Subject: Serious issues at work - Shawwna Harbin
To: <anitabreich@discover.com>, <danielcapozzi@discover.com>, <deapalmer@discover.com>, <gregcarfagna@discover.com>, <susanmarcinko@discover.com>, <tacyhedrick@discover.com>, <tammiemcnerney@discover.com>

I am writing to bring to your attention several serious issues that I have experienced while working at Discover Financial Services. It is important that the company understands the hostile work environment I have been subjected to.

In January 2024, I made a complaint about racial discrimination from one of my colleagues to my manager, Rosanna Blackson. When I made the complaint, Rosanna threatened me with blackmail related to an adjustment issue. I realized then that my job could be in jeopardy, and indeed, I was subsequently falsely accused by Rosanna of job abandonment while I was on a medical leave of absence for my disability. Fortunately, I managed to retain my position, but I was still forced to report to Rosanna. Those days were some of the hardest I've ever experienced. I did not know if I was going to have a job, how I would pay my bills, or how I was going to survive. Things like this should never happen in the workplace, especially at a company like Discover Financial Services.

After returning to work from a medical leave of absence due to my disability, I had a one-on-one meeting with Rosanna where I requested a transfer to another team. Rosanna responded by calling me "nigger." My mother, Tina Harbin, was present with me to witness this racial slur. This slur was deeply disturbing to both myself and my mother. I am racially mixed, but identify and present as African-American, and have a black skin complexion. My mother unfortunately had to raise me in a racially intolerant time period, in which I was repeatedly subjected to race discrimination throughout my life simply for the color of my skin. To see that race discrimination is still alive and well in 2024 and plagues an organization such as Discover Financial Services was deeply unsettling to both of us.

Since that incident in which Rosanna called me a highly offensive racial slur, I have repeatedly requested to move to different roles and departments to escape this hostile work environment and to work under a supervisor who will not retaliate against me for taking medical leave related to

my disability. I was assured that I would be placed on a waitlist for a new schedule, but unfortunately this never happened. Because the company has not taken these issues seriously, I have been forced to file a charge of discrimination with the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission against Discover Financial Services.

I urge you to please take this complaint seriously. Working under someone like Rosanna who has and continues to retaliate against me has been a profoundly traumatic experience. I hope this situation is addressed promptly and that I will not be subjected to further retaliation for filing an EEOC charge, seeking a transfer for my mental health and disability, or for raising concerns about systemic racism at the company.

Shawnna Harbin